

this gap once and for all while undertaking measures for the mechanization of spaces and practices. By the end of the plan period, the railways achieved its objective of a supply capacity in excess of demand. The Fourth Five Year Plan (1966–71) saw huge expansion and development in production capacity. By 1971, after many turbulent years, the railways finally achieved a degree of stability and strength. The Fifth Five Year Plan (1971–76) aimed at consolidating and building upon the gains made during the Fourth plan while the manufacture of diesel and electric locomotives alongside coaches, wagons, and Electric Multiple Units (EMUs) continued on the same scale.

Going local

The initial years were all about becoming independent and to avoid importing equipment, including locomotives. During the British rule, workshops, such as Jamalpur and Ajmer, produced locomotives, albeit in lesser numbers, and the railways imported most of the equipment from Britain. After Independence, low reserves of foreign exchange and the risk of further burdening India's economy meant that the railways could no longer afford to import locomotives and other machinery. British engineer and railway historian OS Nock in his book *Railways of Asia and the Far East* explained that it was essential to source fuel locally and capitalize on India's "large deposits of coal".

Becoming self-sufficient

In the move towards self-sufficiency, large production facilities were set up in various parts of the country. The construction of a locomotive building factory at Chittaranjan began in 1948 and it went into production in 1950. In 1955, the Integral Coach Factory or ICF was established in Chennai, Tamil Nadu, to produce "integral" coaches. The addition of a furnishing division in 1957 meant that it now rolled out complete passenger coaches. The Diesel Locomotive Works (DLW) came up in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh in 1961, which, in its initial years assembled locomotives from imported parts. It soon started manufacturing complete diesel locomotives.